Calicut, and Malappuram. The presence of Moplah or Mappila merchants has been noted in the Indian Ocean world through the centuries. However, the mass migration wave to the Gulf since the 1970s gave birth to a new set of traders and entrepreneurs with businesses of substantial scale.[75] North of Kerala, the Konkani Muslims also had historic trading ties with the Arab world and started coming to Bombay in the 19th century for shipbuilding. Some Konkani Muslim families like the Roghays, Ghattays and Kurs amassed wealth by exporting cotton to China in partnership with the Parsis.[76] More recently, since the Gulf boom, they have been migrating to the Arab world again.

The Maraikkayars are a Tamil Muslim community living along the Coromandel Coast between Nagore and Karaikal with deep migratory and trading traditions.[77] The word ‘marakkalam’ means ‘boat’ in Tamil, and this community has been associated with substantive trade across the Bay of Bengal, where they settled in some of the leading ports and were known to many as the *Chulia*s. They also traded in horses with West Asia and, at one point, were accused of horse-trading in the political affairs of the Melaka court in South East Asia.

In north India, Islam arrived over many centuries, through conquest and trade, conversion and assimilation. Three Muslim communities that stand out in the world of migration and business are the Sunni Memons, and the (mostly) Shi’ite Khojas and Bohras. All of them hail from the region spanning Sindh and Gujarat in the west and had converted from Hindu trading castes such as the Lohanas around the 14th century.[78] Some of their cultural practices, such as those on inheritance, are closer to Hindu customs which reduce the dispersal of wealth. The migratory trajectories of all three communities were extensive in the 19th and 20th centuries both within the subcontinent and towards East Africa and South East Asia.

The Memons migrated from Sindh to various towns in Gujarat, and then using those towns as bases, migrated across the subcontinent in the first half of the 19th century to trade in commodities. They would, in fact, stake a large claim on the lucrative rice trade along the east coast and Burma, using the credit facilitated by their Sindhi counterparts—the Shikarpuri bankers of